

Coping with a breakup

Whether a person made the decision to end a relationship or not, it's normal for them to feel a range of emotions after a breakup, from confusion and sadness to anger, denial, and disbelief. There are active steps teens can take to cope with the emotions caused by a breakup. These steps won't necessarily happen naturally, and so teens may need to push themselves through each stage.



Acknowledgment

A person needs to recognize and accept their feelings before they can move on.



Distraction

Seeing friends and keeping busy helps a person to overcome breakup emotions.



Acceptance

Over time, a person will grow to accept that the relationship is over.



Moving on

As a person accepts the breakup, they become able to look to the future.

Learning from a breakup

It's not possible to change the past, but people can learn from it. It's helpful to think back on the positives and negatives of a relationship.

Think about your last relationship—the good and the bad. What can you bring to a new relationship that you learned from this one?

What did you like about yourself when you were in the relationship? Build on this belief for the future—strong individuals form strong couples.

If thinking about the relationship brings back painful memories, acknowledge them, and then think of ways to avoid this in the future.

Staying friends

Remaining friends with the person on the other side of a breakup can be extremely difficult, particularly if one person did not want the relationship to end. Continuing to lean on the person who ended the relationship can send the other backward in the process—and so most people cut all contact with their exes. However, those who succeed in staying friends often benefit from strong, lifelong friendships.



△ Moving on

Ensuring that both people have enough time and space to recover and move on is the key to staying friends in the future.